

CTM Workshop for Quarto

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Introduction

- First of all, thank you for inviting us to Lund.
- Today, we would like to present Quarto to you.
- (Most of you probably already know it.)
- For those who are new to Quarto, this presentation features a beginner's guide.

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For Beginners

What is Quarto?

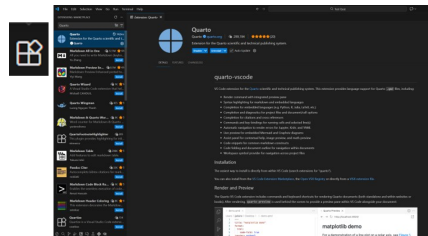
- Website: <https://quarto.org/>
- You write standard Markdown code exactly how you want it to appear.
- You can also embed code (Python, R, Julia, Observable, ...).
- During rendering, the file is scanned for code blocks. These are processed by the respective engine, and the output is sent back to Quarto.
- Quarto then uses Pandoc to format the page using Bootstrap themes.
- Finally, it generates an HTML web page, or if you want other formats such as PDF, .docx, ...

How we use it

- We currently use it to demonstrate how Python can illustrate basic mathematics (like curve analysis) or help visualize matrix transformations.
- For this, we create website projects that include “pyodide-python”, a web-based Python environment allowing users to run code without local installation.
- Michael and others expanded a pyodide-python extension to include AI feedback. Michael can probably explain the technical details.
- Quarto can also be used for interactive learning sessions, including quizzes.

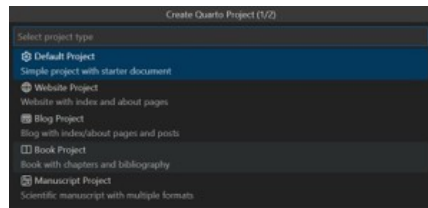
How to get started with Quarto

- Install an IDE of your choice (any text editor works).
- For this guide, we use Visual Studio Code.
- Install VSCode: <https://code.visualstudio.com/download>
- Install Quarto: <https://quarto.org/docs/get-started/>
- Then, install the Quarto extension for VSCode.
- Click the icon in the bottom left to find extensions.



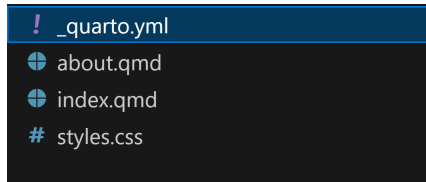
Getting to know Quarto (in VSCode)

- Go to File → New File
- When creating a new Quarto project, the following prompt should appear:
- Here, we select 'Website Project', as that fits our needs.



Getting to know Quarto (in VSCode)

- You should now have 4 files: `_quarto.yml`, `about.qmd`, `index.qmd`, `styles.css`
- These files form the foundation of a Quarto website. You can already render and preview the site (via the terminal with “quarto render” or the render button in the top right of any `.qmd` file).
- The `_quarto.yml` is the configuration file for the website; here you can adjust the core design and global settings.
- Each `.qmd` file has a YAML header (marked by `--` at the top and bottom). Here you can override settings for that specific page.



- `#`, `##`, `###` creates sections, subsections, subsubsections, etc.
- `:::{}` `\dots` `:::` creates callout blocks or tabsets, depending on the content inside `{}`.
- `<details>` `</details>` creates a foldable HTML block. You can add a title using `<summary>` `</summary>` inside.
- ````{} ```` creates a code block. The content of `{}` defines the language.

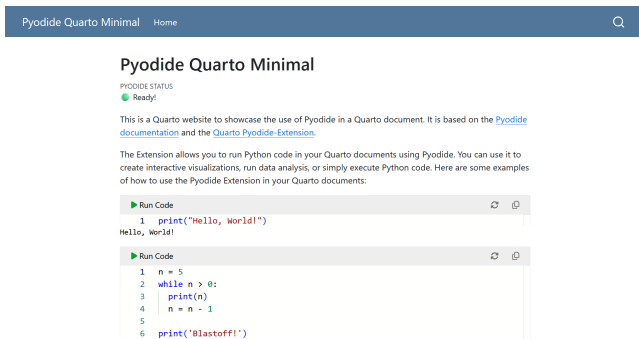
Pyodide-Python

- Pyodide-Python is a web-based Python environment that allows you to run Python without local installation, as all computing is done in the browser.
- This is especially useful for giving students an easy entry into using Python for **Computational Thinking in Mathematics**.
- The extension can be installed via the terminal with `quarto add coatless-quarto/pyodide`.
- The extension is open-source and can be found at:
<https://github.com/coatless-quarto/pyodide>

Pyodide-Python

- To use the extension in your .qmd files, you have to add filters: - pyodide to the YAML header.
- Afterward, you can use `‘‘‘{pyodide-python} \dots ‘‘‘` to embed Python code blocks into the page.
- For example: `‘‘‘{pyodide-python} print("Hello World") ‘‘‘` will create a code block containing `print("Hello World")`, which can be edited and executed on the website.

```
1 ---
2 title: "Pyodide Quarto Minimal"
3 filters:
4   - pyodide
5 ---
```

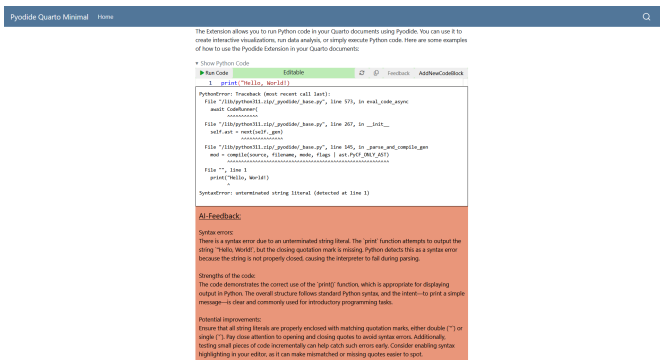


A minimal example of a website using the Pyodide-Extension can be found in this repository or directly at: https://gitlab.ruhr-uni-bochum.de/ctm/lund-meeting/-/tree/main/Pyodide%20Quarto%20Minimal?ref_type=heads

AI-Feedback within Pyodide Python

- At Ruhr-University Bochum, we modified the **Coatless-pyodide** extension to include AI feedback.
- The extension works very similarly to the original but adds the ability to ask an AI for help with the code.
- To use this feature, users must provide a valid **API Key** and **Base URL**.

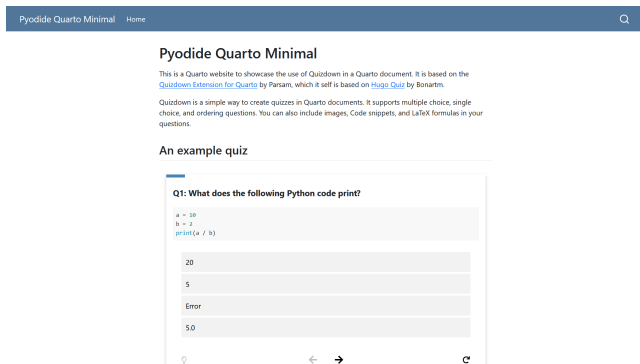
Pyodide-Python with AI-Feedback in Action



A minimal example of a website using the modified Pyodide-Extension can be found in this repository or directly at: https://gitlab.ruhr-uni-bochum.de/ctm/lund-meeting/-/tree/main/Pyodide-Feedback%20Minimal?ref_type=heads

Quarto Quizzes

- Gamification can greatly enhance learning, so we wanted to provide a gamified experience in our tutorials.
- For this purpose, we looked and found the **Quizdown** extension:
`https://github.com/parmsam/quarto-quizdown`
- Quizdown allows you to create single-choice, multiple-choice, and ordering quizzes without much extra effort.



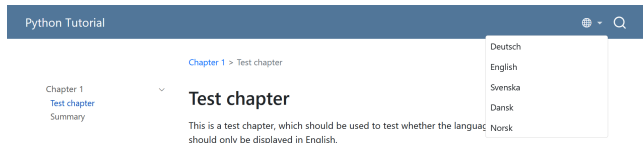
A minimal example of a website with Quizdown can be found in this repository or directly at:
[https://gitlab.ruhr-uni-bochum.de/ctm/lund-meeting/-/tree/main/Quizdown%20Minimal?
ref_type=heads](https://gitlab.ruhr-uni-bochum.de/ctm/lund-meeting/-/tree/main/Quizdown%20Minimal?ref_type=heads)

Multilanguage Website Projects

Multilanguage Website Projects

- As this is an international project, we wanted to give users the ability to switch between languages in Quarto.
- Currently, there is no official feature to switch languages within a specific part of the website; it only supports redirecting to a different homepage.
- Therefore, we wrote a small Python script that modifies the navbar to include a dropdown menu, allowing users to switch languages while staying on the same page.
- There is also the small problem of “quarto preview” not supporting the dropdown menu, but you can host the website locally and then everything works fine, the local hosting and previewing in the browser is also included in the python script.

Multilanguage Website Projects in Action



A minimal example of a website with multi-language support (I hope the AI translations aren't too bad!) can be found in this repository or directly at: https://gitlab.ruhr-uni-bochum.de/ctm/lund-meeting/-/tree/main/Multilanguage%20Website%20Setup?ref_type=heads

Conclusion

Conclusion

- Quarto is a powerful tool for creating interactive and engaging educational content, especially in the context of Computational Thinking in Mathematics.
- There is a vast number of extensions available, providing many possibilities to enhance the student experience.
- As some of you have already seen, Quarto is a user-friendly tool for creating scripts, as it allows you to combine code and output in a single file.

All materials from this presentation and the slides can be found at:

<https://gitlab.ruhr-uni-bochum.de/ctm/lund-meeting>